Honeypot

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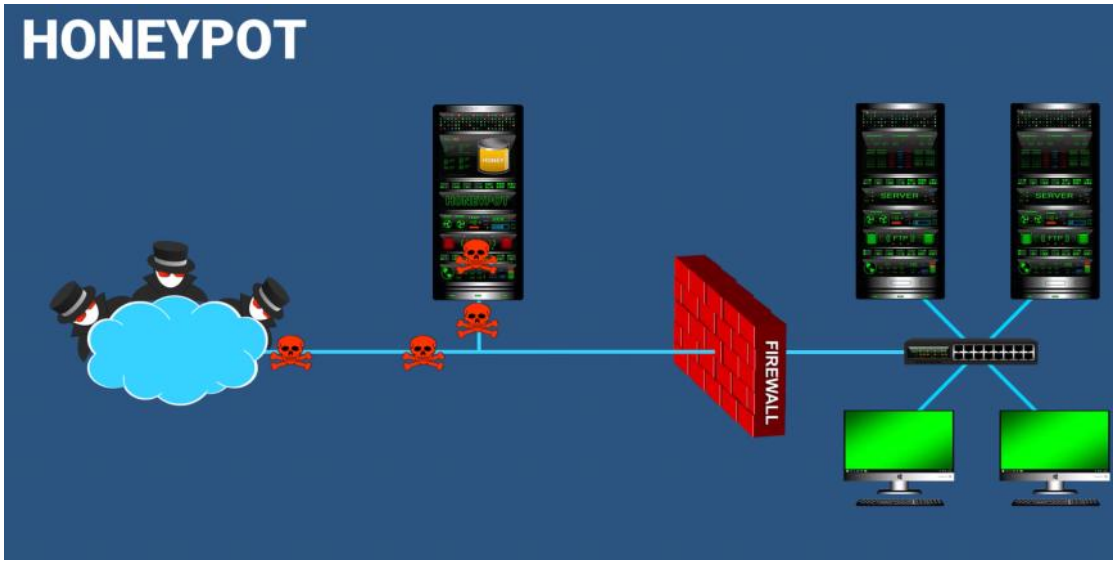
A honeypot is a cybersecurity mechanism designed to lure cyber criminals away from a real network. By creating a decoy server —often filled with fake data and intentionally left with vulnerabilities like weak passwords or open ports—organizations can trap attackers and observe their techniques, tools, and intentions in a controlled environment.



Key concepts include:

- Honey nets: A more sophisticated setup involving multiple honeypots, used to catch experienced attackers who might otherwise detect and avoid a single trap.
- Email traps (spam traps): Fake email addresses placed in hidden locations on a network to identify and block spammers.
- Spider honeypots: Fake web pages containing hidden links that specifically target bots and web crawlers, allowing organizations to monitor and block malicious automated traffic.

Interaction levels are used to categorize honeypots:

- Low interaction: Simple and cost-effective to set up, these gather basic information such as threat type and source IP, though they generally lack the depth to engage attackers for long.
- High interaction: More complex and resource-intensive, these use sophisticated tools to keep criminals engaged for an extended period, providing deeper insights into their specific strategies and targets.